

Many countries have great economies, but few have craft and culture. There may be things that China can do today that India cannot; yet, through craft, India has the competitive advantage

skills, ensuring their continuity. When craft and culture skip a generation, they never return.

By the time India turns 100, the demand for luxury goods will be driven by craft and authenticity. Many giants in the industry will have fallen, consumed by a greed of scale and the resulting mediocrity. New heroes

championing craft will rise. Luxury brands will have to define themselves with craft provenance and not with influencers and marketing. This is India's biggest opportunity. I maintain India is a first-world country in terms of culture, wisdom, and sophistication. The problem has always been how Indians perceive India.

I tell my human resources team our blue-collar workers are unparalleled heroes; the problem is with the white-collar employees. We need to mentor and inspire white-collar business leaders and managers to help the blue-collar rise to their fullest potential. Idealism is a necessary pillar for a business as long-term as luxury.

Today, global luxury brands are silently and stealthily setting up factories in India. Companies with the strongest craft base will wear the crown of glory in luxury's future. If we do not learn to respect and preserve what is ours, we will be giving away the Kohinoor that adorns the crown once more. **BT**

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